



Premiere Pro isn't for the faint of heart, but whether you're creating a family vacation DVD or your own "I'm-going-to-be-a-YouTube-star" video, it's the ultimate tool for video editing. We're going to assume you've been through the "Getting Started" part of Premiere's help file, so don't get all acidic if you can't understand the instructions here.

ADOBE PREMIERE PRO CS3

Get Your USB Microphone Working

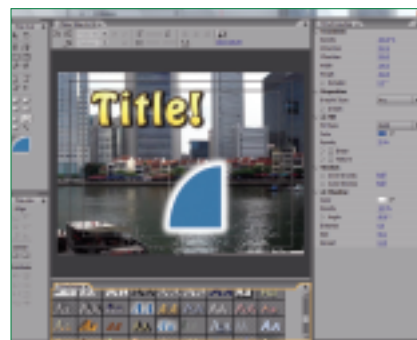
If you've got a USB microphone—this may well be the one on your webcam or USB headset—and it isn't working with Premiere, there's a simple fix. First, in Windows XP's Sound Control Panel applet, make sure you've selected your microphone as the default recording device (Control Panel > Sound and Audio Devices > Audio). In Premiere, go to Edit > Preferences > Audio Hardware and click on the ASIO Settings button. Under DirectSound Input Ports, select your USB microphone.

Working With Titles

Every movie needs introductory credits. To start with yours, go to File > New > Title. The dialog you see is replete with all sorts of text tools, not to mention drawing tools, should you feel the need to add shapes to your title. At the bottom of the dialog, you'll find an assortment of styles that you can apply to the title—these work pretty much the same way as Layer Styles in Photoshop.

Once you've created a title, drag it from the Project panel to the Timeline panel and place it in one of the four

video slots—usually the topmost, but we won't judge you if you choose another. Besides the obvious purpose, you



Tell the world what your movie is about!

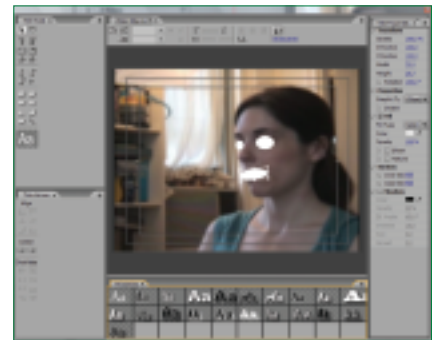
can also use titles to create masks and use in other effects—we'll come to those in a bit.

The Magic Of Track Matte

The Track Matte effect can be used in Premiere the same way adjustment layers and masks can be used in Photoshop. If you're not familiar with the latter, forget about it and read on. For example, if you've got a close-up shot of yourself, you can use the Track Matte effect to hide all those pores and skin blemishes without losing detail around the eyes and mouth—where your viewers are most likely to notice your tampering.

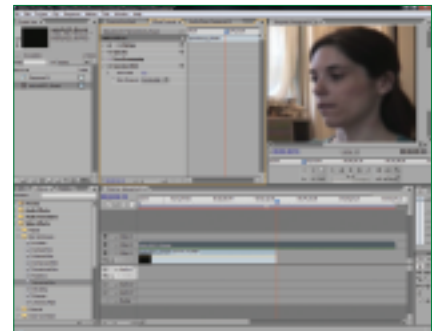
First, duplicate the video clip in the Timeline panel—we'll be using this duplicate to clear out all the blemishes. Now scrub (that's "drag the progress indicator") over to the shot in question—this will help you place the track matte. Go to File > New > Title to bring up the Title dialog, and use the ellipse tool to draw ellipses over the eyes and mouth. They don't have to be entirely accurate—just not too much bigger than said facial features.

In the Effects panel, choose Gaussian Blur under Video



This is what your title should look like

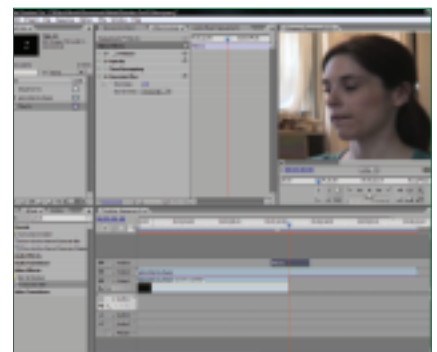
Effects > Blur and Sharpen (we prefer using the search text box in the panel—just type in "gauss" and you'll have your results). Drag the effect onto the upper video. In the Effect Controls panel, expand the Gaussian Blur effect and adjust the Blurriness till you're satisfied all the blemishes are gone. You might have to adjust the opacity to avoid edges looking too blurry, too. Ignoring the eyes and mouth



You've smoothened the skin, now to bring back the details in the eyes

for now, stop when you're satisfied with the way the shot looks. Now drag the title you made into the video track above this clip.

Finally, get to the Track Matte Key effect in the Effects Panel (it's under Keying) and drag it on to the video you blurred. In the Effect Controls panel, expand Track Matte Key and in the drop-down menu next to Matte, select the video track that has your title. You'll find that the ellipses



Voila! No more blemishes!